MIL-B-2873D(NU)
12 March 1985
SUPERSEDING
MIL-B-2873C(SA)
24 January 1978

MILITARY SPECIFICATION

BOAT CLOTH

This specification is approved for use by the Navy Clothing and Textile Research Facility, Department of the Navy and is available for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

1. SCOPE

1.1 Scope. This specification covers the requirements for blue or white boat cloths fabricated from wool broadcloth or cotton twill, as applicable.

1.2 Classification. The boat cloths shall be of one type with black stripes and in the following classes and styles.

Class 1 - Blue Cloth
Class 2 - White Cloth
Style A - For Fleet Admiral
Style B - For Admirals
Style C - For Vice-Admirals
Style D - For Rear Admirals
Style E - For Commodores
Style F - For Commanding Officers
Style G - For Wardroom Officers

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 Government documents.

2.1.1 Specification, standards, and handbooks. Unless otherwise specified, the following specifications, standards and handbooks of the issue listed in that issue of the Department of Defense Index of Specifications and Standards (DoDISS) specified in the solicitation form a part of this specification to the extent specified.

Beneficial comments (recommendations, additions, deletions) and any pertinent data which may be of use in improving this document should be addressed to: Officer in Charge, Navy Clothing and Textile Research Facility, 21 Strathmore Road, Natick, MA 01760-2490 by using the self-addressed Standardization Document Improvement Proposal (DD Form 1426) appearing at the end of this document or by letter.

FSC 7210

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SPECIFICATIONS

FEDERAL

V-T-276	- Thread, Cotton
CCC-C-461	- Cloth, Uniform, Twill, Cotton
DDD-T-86	- Tape, Textile, Cotton, General Purpose (Unbleached, Bleached or Dyed)

MILITARY

MIL-B-593	- Braid, Textile (flat)
MIL-B-17757	- Boxes, Shipping, Fiberboard (Modular Sizes)
MIL-C-16290	- Cloth, Melton, Wool (Moth-Proofed)
MIL-C-29127	- Cloth, Twill, Polyester/Cotton
MIL-C-82252	- Cloth, Wool, Broadcloth (Moth-proofed)
MIL-T-43548	- Thread, Polyester, Cotton-Covered and Rayon-Covered

STANDARDS

FEDERAL

FED-STD-751	- Stitches, Seams and Stitchings

MILITARY

MIL-STD-105	- Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes
MIL-STD-129	- Marking for Shipment and Storage
MIL-STD-147	- Palletized Unit Loads

(Copies of specifications, standards, drawings, and publications required by contractors in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

2.1.2 Other Government documents, drawings, and publications. The following other Government documents, drawings and publications form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein.

LAWS AND REGULATIONS

US POSTAL SERVICE MANUAL

(Copies of the manual may be obtained from the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402.)

2.2 Other publications. The following documents form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. The issued of documents which are indicated as DoD adopted shall be the issue listed in the current DoDISS and supplement thereto, if applicable.

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NATIONAL MOTOR FREIGHT TRAFFIC ASSOCIATION, INC., AGENT
National Motor Freight Classification

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Trucking Association, ATTN; Traffic Department, 1616 P. Street N. W., Washington, D. C. 20036)

UNIFORM CLASSIFICATION COMMITTEE, AGENT

Uniform Freight Classification

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Uniform Classification Committee, Room 1106, 222 South Riverside Plaza, Chicago, IL 60606.)

2.3 Order of precedence. In the event of a conflict between the text of this document and the references cited herein, the text of this document shall take precedence.

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1. Guide sample. Samples, when furnished, are solely for guidance and information to the contractor (see 6.3). Variation from this specification may appear in the sample, in which case this specification shall govern.

3.2. First article. When specified, the contractor shall furnish sample boat cloths for first article inspection and approval (see 4.3 and 6.2.).

3.3 Materials.

3.3.1 Cloth, Blue. The basic cloth for the class 1 boat cloth shall be shade Blue 3346 wool broadcloth conforming to Type I, class 1, 3 or 5 of MIL-C-82252. As an alternate a shade Blue 3346 wool melton conforming to Type I, class 2 of MIL-C-16290 may be used.

3.3.2 Cloth, White. The basic cloth for the class 2 boat cloth shall be shade White 3006 cotton twill conforming to Type III or IV of CCC-C-461. As an alternate a shade White 3053, polyester and cotton twill conforming to class 2 of MIL-C-29127 may be used.

3.3.3. Braid, Textile (flat). The material used for the stripes on the class 1 boat cloth shall be monair, dyed black conforming to type I, class 3 of MIL-B-593. The widths shall be 1 inch and 2-1/2 inches. As an alternate a flat textile braid conforming to requirements stated in 3.3.3.1 may be used.

3.3.3.1 Braid, Textile (flat) Alternate. As an alternate to the braid used on the class 1 boat cloth and cotton tape used on the class 2 boat cloth, the 1 inch and 2 1/4 inch braid, dyed black, of Type III, class 2 of MIL-B-593 may be used.

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3.3.4 Tape, cotton. The cotton tape used for the stripe on the class 2 boat cloth shall be black, conforming to type III, class 3 of DDD-T-86 except that the widths shall be 1 inch and 2 1/2 inch. The total warp yarns for the 2 1/2 inch tape shall be 164. As an alternate a flat textile braid conforming to the requirements stated in 3.3.3.1 may be used.

3.3.5 Thread.

3.3.5.1 Thread, Polyester, Covered. The thread used for stitching the class 1 boat cloth and braid shall be black AA, CA 66043. The thread for stitching class 2 boat cloth shall be white AH, CA 66050 and for stitching the tape or braid the thread shall be black AA, CA 66043. The above threads shall conform to ticket Nos. 24 through 70, 2 or 3 ply of MIL-T-43548. As an alternate to the polyester covered thread, a cotton thread conforming to type 1A3 or 1A2, ticket Nos. 20 through 70 (minimum 33g/Km), 3 ply of V-T-276, in respective color may be used.

3.4 Design. The boat cloth shall have a black stripe on a blue or white background as applicable. The class 1 boat cloth shall have a blue background and the class 2 boat cloth shall have a white background. The type and arrangement of the stripes shall be as specified in 3.6 and figure 1.

3.4.1 Figure. Figure 1 is furnished for information purposes only. To the extent of any inconsistencies between the written specification and the figure, the written specification shall govern.

3.5 Stitches, seams and stitching. The stitch seam and stitching types for the boat cloths shall conform to FED-STD-751. Stitch type 301 shall be used with a minimum of 10 and a maximum of 14 stitches per inch.

3.5.1 Seams. The finished boat cloths shall contain one overlap seam. The seam type shall be LSa-2 with a 1/2 to 9/16 inch gauge, each row being 1/16 inch from each edge. The seam shall be parallel with the warp direction of the fabric. The seam for the blue boat cloth may contain either selvage or cut edges and shall be a minimum of 13 inches from and parallel to one edge. The seam for the white boat cloth shall contain only selvage edges and be 36 (± 1) inches from and parallel to one edge.

3.5.2 Stripes. The stripes shall be made with the braid or tape as applicable. The braid or tape shall be of one piece and shall be sewn to the background material using seam type LSa-1 (each edge) with each row of stitching approximately 1/16 inch from the edge. Each stripe shall start and end at the same corner and the ends of the stripe shall be concealed within the folded corner. The braid or tape at the corners of the boat cloth shall be folded and stitched as indicated in figure 1.

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3.5.3 Border. A finished border of 3 (+1/4) inches shall be left beyond the outside edge of the braid or tape. The cloths shall have a 1/2 to 5/8 inch turned under hem around the entire periphery. The hem for the blue boat cloth shall be made with stitching type EFa-1 with the line of stitching approximately 1/16 inch from the raw edge. The hem for the white boat cloth shall be made with stitching type EFb-1 with the line of stitching approximately 1/16 inch from the folded edge.

3.5.4 Thread breaks and ends of seams. Ends of all seams and stitchings when not caught in other seams or stitching shall be backtacked not less than 3/8 inch. Thread breaks shall be repaired by stitching not less than 1/2 inch at each end of the break.

3.6 Manufacturing operations requirements. The boat cloths shall be manufactured using the stitches, seams and stitchings as specified in 3.5. The number, widths and arrangement of the stripes shall be as specified in the following paragraphs. The arrangement of the stripes in the following paragraphs all commence at the left hand border. A +3/32 inch tolerance is allowed between adjacent stripes.

3.6.1 Style A - Fleet Admiral. The cloths shall have three stripes, i.e., two stripes 2 1/2 inches wide and one stripe 1 inch wide between the two wide stripes, with a 1 inch wide space between the adjacent stripes (see figure 1).

3.6.2 Style A - Fleet Admiral. The cloths shall have four stripes, i.e., one stripe 2 1/2 inches wide and three stripes 1 inch wide respectively, with a 1 inch wide space between the adjacent stripes (see figure 1.)

3.6.3 Style C - For Vice Admirals. The cloths shall have three stripes, i.e., one stripe 2 1/2 inch wide and two stripes 1 inch wide respectively, with a 1 inch wide space between the adjacent stripes (see figure 1).

3.6.4 Style D - For Rear Admirals. The cloths shall have two stripes, i.e., one stripe 2 1/2 inches wide and one stripe 1 inch wide, respectively, with a 1 inch wide space between the stripes (see figure 1).

3.6.5 Style E - For Commodores. The cloths shall have one stripe 2 1/2 inches wide (see figure 1).

3.6.6 Style F - For Commanders and Captains. The cloths shall have three stripes for Commanders or four stripes for Captains each 1 inch wide, with a 3/4 inch wide space between the adjacent stripes (see figure 1).

3.6.7 Style G - For Wardroom Officers. The cloths shall have two stripes, each 1 inch wide with a 3/4 inch wide space between the stripes (see figure 1).

3.7 Dimensions. The boat cloth shall be 72 (+1/2) inches in length by 72 (+1/2) inches in width.

3.8 Workmanship. The finished boat cloth shall conform to the quality of product established by this specification. The occurrence of defects shall not exceed the applicable acceptable quality levels.

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4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as other wise specified in the contract, the contractor may utilize his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.1.1 Certificate of compliance. Where certificates of compliance are submitted, the Government reserves the right to check test such items to determine the validity of the certification.

4.2 Classification of inspection. The inspection requirements specified herein are classified as follows:

1. First article inspection (see 4.3).
2. Quality conformance inspection (see 4.4).

4.3 First article inspection. The first article submitted in accordance with 3.2 shall be inspected as specified in 4.4.2 for compliance with design, construction, workmanship and dimensional requirements.

4.4 Quality conformance inspection. Inspection shall be in accordance with the provisions set forth in MIL-STD-105, except where otherwise indicated herein.

4.4.1 Component and material inspection. In accordance with 4.1, components and materials shall be inspected and tested in accordance with all the requirements of referenced specifications, drawings, and standards unless otherwise excluded, amended, modified, or qualified in this specification or applicable purchase document.

4.4.2 Examination of the end item. Examination of the end item shall be in accordance with 4.4.2.1 and 4.4.2.2. The applicable inspection levels and acceptable quality levels (AQL's) shall be as indicated in 4.4.2.3. The sample unit shall be one completely fabricated boatcloth. The lot size shall be expressed in units of boatcloths.

4.4.2.1 Visual examination. The boat cloth shall be examined for defects classified in accordance with the list below:

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Defect	Classification Major	Minor
MATERIAL DEFECTS AND WORKMANSHIP DAMAGES		
a. Any hole, cut or tear	x	
b. Weakening defect such as slub, smash, float	x	
c. Two or more continuous broken or missing ends or picks in the basic material	x	
d. Clearly noticeable double pick, coursepick or mispick.	x	
e. Any part shaded		x
f. Any mend or burn	x	
g. Not material specified	x	
h. Not color specified	x	
CLEANNESS		
a. Any spot or stain		x
b. Five or more thread ends not trimmed to 3/8 inch or less		x
CONSTRUCTION AND WORKMANSHIP		
a. Operation omitted or not accomplished as specified	x	
b. Piecing of boat cloth not as specified	x	
c. Component not of required type, class or size		x
d. Boat cloths not finished square		x
SEAMS AND STITCHING		
a. Needle chew	x	
b. Not specified seam or stitch type	x	
c. Any line of stitching omitted or insecure	x	
d. Any part of boat cloth caught in any unrelated operation or stitching	x	
e. Ends of stitching when not caught in another seam or stitching backtacked less than 3/8 inch		x
f. Stitching overlapping ends of thread break less than 1/2 inch		x
g. Raw edge exceeding 1/2 inch (only applicable on hem of Class 2 boat cloth)		x
h. Loose tension resulting in a loose seam	x	
i. Overlap seam not as specified	x	
j. Tight tension (stitches break when normal strain is applied in direction of the seam or stitching)	x	
k. Stitches per inch (score only when condition exists on major portion of seam or stitching)		

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SEAMS AND STITCHING (CONT'D)		
1. Less than the minimun		x
2. More than the maximum		x
l. Seams twisted, pleated or puckered	x	
m. Open seams		
1. 3/4 inch or less		x
2. More than 3/4 inch	x	
n. Two or more continuous skipped, broken, or runoff stitches		x
THREAD		
a. Color of thread other than specified	x	
b. Not type specified	x	
HEMS		
A. Hem omitted	x	
b. Hem twisted, puckered, badly pleated or not uniform in width		x
c. Hem on wrong side	x	
STRIPES		
A. Wrong arrangement	x	
D. Spacing between stripes not within specified tolerance		x

4.4.2.2 Dimensional examination. The boat cloth shall be examined for defects in dimension as specified in 3.7. Any deviation from the dimensions and tolerances specified will constitute a defect.

4.4.2.3 Inspection levels and acceptable quality levels. The inspection levels and acceptable quality levels (AQL's) expressed as defects per 100 units, shall be as follows:

	AQL's	Inspection Level
For examination in 4.4.2.1:		
Major	2.5	II
Total (Major and Minor combined)	6.5	II
For examination in 4.4.2.2:		
One class	4.0	S-3

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4.4.3 Examination of packaging requirements. An examination shall be made to determine that the packaging, packing, and marking complies with Section 5 requirements. Defects shall be scored in accordance with the list below. The sample unit shall be one shipping container fully prepared for delivery except that it need not be closed. Defects of closure listed below shall be examined on shipping containers fully prepared for delivery. The lot size shall be the number of shipping containers in the end item inspection lot. The inspection level shall be S-2 and the AQL shall be 2.5 defects per hundred units.

Examine	Defect
Marking (exterior and interior)	Omitted, incorrect, illegible, of improper size, location, sequence, or method of application
Materials	Any component missing, damaged or not as specified.
Workmanship	Inadequate application of components, such as incomplete closure of container flaps, loose strapping, improper taping, or inadequate stapling. Open and non-continuous heat sealed seams and closure of polyethylene bag. Bulged or distorted containers.
Content	Number of Boat cloths per shipping container is more or less than required.

*4.4.4. Palletization examination. An examination shall be made to determine that the palletization complies with the section 5 requirements. Defects shall be scored in accordance with the list below. The sample unit shall be one palletized unit load fully packaged. The lot size shall be the number of palletized unit loads in the end item inspection lot. The inspection level shall be S-1 and the AQL, expressed in terms of defects per hundred units, shall be 6.5.

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Examine	Defect
Finished dimensions	Length, width, or height exceeds specified maximum requirements.
Palletization	Pallet pattern not as specified. Interlocking of loads not as specified. Load not bonded with required straps as specified.
Weight	Exceeds maximum load limits.
Marking	Omitted; incorrect; illegible; of improper size, location, sequence, or method of application.

5. PACKAGING

5.1 Preservation-Packaging. Packaging shall be level A or C (see 6.2).

5.1.1 Level A. Each boat cloth shall be folded as follows:

Fold in quarters to approximate dimension of 36 x 36 inches. Fold one end in approximately 6 inches and one side in approximately 13 inches, so that the item is approximately 23 by 30 inches. Fold 30 inch dimension in half so that the folded item shall measure approximately 15 by 23 inches. Each folded boat cloth shall be individually packaged in a clear snug-fitting polyethylene bag. The film shall be 0.0015 (± 20 percent tolerance) inch thickness. All seams and closures shall be formed by heat sealing. Prior to or during the heat-sealing closure operation, excess air within the bag shall be expelled.

5.1.2 Level C. (commercial packaging). Boat cloths shall be packaged to afford adequate protection against physical damage during shipment from the supply source to the first receiving activity. The package and the quantity per package shall be the same as that normally used by the contractor for retail distribution.

5.2 Packing. Packing shall be level A, B or C (See 6.2).

5.2.1 Level A. Five (5) class 1 boat cloths, or eight (8) class 2 boat cloths, of one style only, packaged as specified in 5.1., shall be packed flat in a fiberboard container. Each package shall be reversed end to end, and the length of the packages shall be parallel to the side panels of the container. The fiberboard shipping container shall be assembled, closed and reinforced conforming to type CF class weather-resistant, variety DW, grade V15c, size 2A of MIL-B-17757. The fiberboard for the liner shall conform to type CF, class domestic, of MIL-B-17757.

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5.2.2 Level B. Five (5) class 1 boat cloths, or eight (8) class 2 boat cloths, of one style only, packaged as specified in 5.1.1, shall be packed flat in a fiberboard container. Each package shall be reversed end to end, and the length of the packages shall be parallel to the side panels of the container. The fiberboard shipping container shall be assembled, closed, and reinforced conforming to type CF class domestic,variety DW, grade 200, size 2A of MIL-B-17757. The fiberboard for the liner shall conform to type CF, class domestic, of MIL-B-17757.

5.2.3 Level C (Commercial). Boat cloths, packaged as specified in 5.1 shall be packed in a manner to insure carrier acceptance and safe delivery at destination at the lowest transportation rate for such supplies. The quantity per shipping container shall be the same as that normally used by the supplier for retail distribution. Containers shall comply with the U.S. Postal Service Manual, Uniform Freight Classification Rules or National Motor Freight Classification Rules as applicable.

*5.3 Palletization. When specified (see 6.2), cloth, packed as specified in 5.2, shall be palletized on a 4-way entry pallet in accordance with load type I of MIL-STD-147. Each prepared load shall be bonded with primary and secondary straps in accordance with the bonding means K and L, or film bonding means P. Pallet patterns shall be in accordance with the appendix of MIL-STD-147. Interlocking of loads shall be effected be reversing the pattern of each course. If the container is of a size which does not conform to any of the patterns specified in MIL-STD-147, the pallet pattern used shall first be approved by the contracting officer.

5.4 Marking. In addition to any special marking required by the contract or order, shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

5.4.1 Polyethylene bagged packages. Polyethylene bagged packages shall have the required information legibly printed or stamped in black directly on the bag across the center face or on a white paper label inserted within the bag so as to permit ready indentification. The bag or label shall indicate the following information:

STOCK NUMBER
NOMENCLATURE
QUANTITY

6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use. The boat cloths covered by this specification are intended to identify officers in command.

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6.2 Ordering data. Procurement documents should specify the following.

a. Title, number, and date of this specification.
b. Class and style required (see 1.2).
*c. When first article inspection is required (see 3.2), the item will be tested and should be a first article sample. The contracting officer should include specific instructions in acquisition documents regarding arrangements for examinations, quantity, and testing and approval.
d. Selection of applicable levels of packaging and packing (see 5.1 and 5.2).
*e. When palletization is required (see 5.3).

6.3 Samples. For access to samples, address the procuring office issuing the invitation for bids (see 3.1).

6.4 Changes from previous issue. The margins of this specification are marked with an asterisk to indicate where changes (additions, modifications, corrections, deletions) from the previous issue were made. This was done as a convenience only and the Government assumes no liability whatsoever for any inaccuracies in these notations. Bidders and contractors are cautioned to evaluate the requirements of this document based on the entire content irrespective of the marginal notations and relationship to the last previous issue.

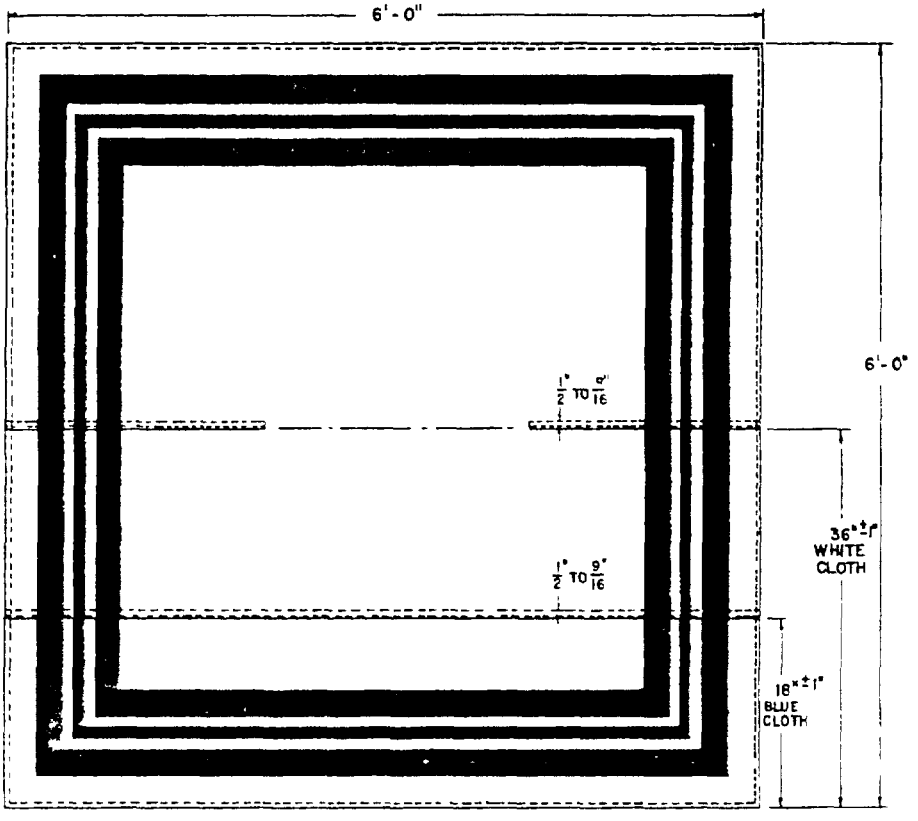
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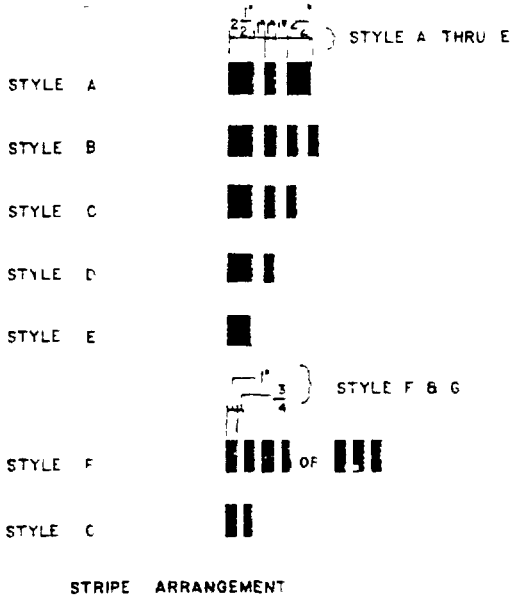
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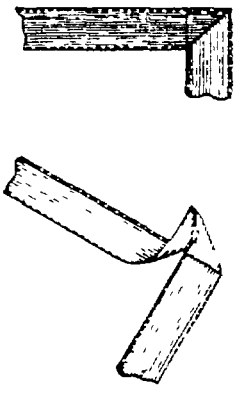
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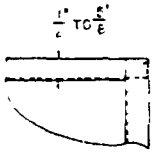
BOAT CLOTH



STRIPE ARRANGEMENT



STRIPE STITCHING



CLOTH HEM STITCHING
(UNDERSIDE)

Figure 1

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NOTE. This form may not be used to request copies of documents, nor to request waivers, deviations, or clarification of specification requirements on current contracts. Comments submitted on this form do not constitute or imply authorization to waive any portion of the referenced document*(s)* or to amend contractual requirements.

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STANDARDIZATION DOCUMENT IMPROVEMENT PROPOSAL

(See Instructions – Reverse Side)

1. DOCUMENT NUMBER	2 DOCUMENT TITLE
MIL-B-2873D(NU)	BOAT CLOTH

3a. NAME OF SUBMITTING ORGANIZATION	4 TYPE OF ORGANIZATION *(Mark one)*
	☐ VENDOR
	☐ USER
b ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)*	☐ MANUFACTURER
	☐ OTHER *(Specify)* _____

5 PROBLEM AREAS

a. Paragraph Number and Wording

b Recommended Wording

c Reason/Rationale for Recommendation

6 REMARKS

7a. NAME OF SUBMITTER *(Last, First, MI)* – Optional	b WORK TELEPHONE NUMBER *(Include Area Code)* – Optional
c MAILING ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)* – Optional	8. DATE OF SUBMISSION *(YYMMDD)*

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